- The tree is found in southern tropical dry deciduous forests.

8.
   - The Mines and Mineral (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 (MMDR Act, 1957) was amended through the MMDR Amendment Act, 2015. One of the amendment provided for the establishment of District Mineral Foundation (DMF) in any district affected by mining related operations.
   - The objective of the DMF is to work for the interest and benefit of persons, and areas affected by mining related operations.
9. Gulf Cooperation Council is an intergovernmental political and economic union consisting of Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and the United Arab Emirates.
10.
   - Shale gas is natural gas that is found trapped within sedimentary rocks.
   - India has an estimated 96 trillion cubic feet (tcf) of recoverable shale gas reserves, found mainly in Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Rajasthan.
   - In India, six basins have been identified as potentially shale gas bearing basins– Cambay, Assam-Arakan, Gondwana, Krishna-Godavari, Cauveri and the Indo-Gangetic plain.
11.
   - Drip irrigation is a type of micro-irrigation that has the potential to save water and nutrients by allowing water to drip slowly to the roots of plants.
   - Weeds, in order to grow, require water in fields. However, drip irrigation provides water mostly to plants and water is not spread on the field. This inhibits growth of weed.
   - Flooding of fields lead to salinity. Drip irrigation may reduce soil salinity since it does not spread water on fields.
   - Drip irrigation may reduce soil erosion since water is sprayed slowly to roots of plants.
   - Hence all the three options are correct. However, there is no option of 1,2 and 3. Hence, the next best answer is 1 and 3.
12. The river linking project is large scale project of GOI that aims to connect the various rivers by network of reservoir and canal in